Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Monet Bags

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Chief Financial Officer of the Meridian Museum

Monet can locate a missing cent faster than anyone can locate the missing antiquity. Monet can tell you exactly how much tonight's floral installation cost, which donor paid for it, and which line item everyone is pretending it came from.

• Works with **Artie Ficial** and **Sue Venir** on museum budgets and donor agreements.

• Checks **Brie DeVivre**'s catering bills. **Brie** needs to explain every extra charge.

• **Elon Mosaic** keeps suggesting new museum technology. Monet keeps asking who will pay for it.

ACTING TIPS

Quick, pragmatic, wry, unimpressed by grandeur for grandeur's sake. You notice costs other people pretend not to see. You're not afraid to spend money as long as it's a wise investment.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Monet Bags. I'm the CFO and I oversee the numbers. Please enjoy the gala, but know that any additional expenditures will not be reimbursed without a receipt.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

She grew up watching a parent wait for wages that did not arrive. Missing payroll is personal, not an abstract budget failure.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *The object that borrows your face has something above its reflection.*

2 *The painted world draws your gaze. The clue prefers its hidden reverse.*

3 *A soft cushion in the color of a clear sky conceals something behind it.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Friday. That's when wages are due. Grant's check could cover our staff; his terms let him inspect every transfer. I won't have the cleaners waiting by the phone while he decides which chair his name should go on. Artie wanted his authority protected. I wanted payroll covered. And yes, I told Grant he could keep his check if the price was treating us like thieves.

IF MURDERER

> Friday. That's when wages are due. My mother used to wait by the phone on payday. I know what that does to a household. I'd moved money to pay our staff. Grant wanted the books before releasing his check, and the board wanted answers too. Artie hated losing authority. I had transfers to explain and no time left to explain them.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> The extra-course ticket came to accounts. I crossed out our account and took Grant's copy to his place. Glass waiting; no Grant. I took my transfer slip away again. The payroll transfer had board authorization. He didn't need to inspect it privately. Brie, send the supplier to me. Don't send me another speech about what the donor expects.

IF MURDERER

> The manager brought the cheese ticket to accounts. I crossed out our account and sent the donor copy back. The restricted-fund transfer was still off the board's agenda. Grant wanted my books before releasing his donation. I went to his private place to get a signature; his glass was waiting, he wasn't. I stayed with the unsigned bill for a bit. Brie, whose money did he think kept appearing whenever he asked for something? Mine? Yours?



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Serve the original order, bill the addition to Grant. Those were my instructions. The toast stayed booked. I had authority to move that money into wages. The payroll line saying authorization absent is an office problem. Artie, don't ask me to find a different way to say that. Somebody had to get them paid.

IF MURDERER

> I looked for Grant before the preview. His glass was set out, unwrapped, beside the invoice. He wasn't there. I left his copy for signing and returned to accounts. The cheese argument continued later. So did payroll. Artie, don't tell them we all agreed. We didn't. I was the one expected to find the money.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

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BALLOT

Monet Bags

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't kill Grant. The toast stayed booked; my private visit was over the bill. I lied about board authorization. There wasn't any. I moved restricted money into wages because Friday was coming. Calling the missing approval an office problem didn't make one appear. Artie, when they freeze that account, tell the cleaners I paid them. Don't ask them to be grateful for what comes next.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The accounts argument happened, and I sent the ticket back with the manager. My separate visit to find Grant was after the preview, while his unwrapped glass was waiting. I used poison I'd taken from the bottle. I told you that visit was before the preview; the manager had not even set out the glass then. I had already used restricted money for payroll. Grant wanted to examine the books and control the rescue. The wages were paid. That is the small fact I kept hiding behind. A family is waiting for a man who will never come home, and I made that happen.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.